
Department Committees for AY 24

From Chemical Faculty Listserv <CHE-FACULTY@LISTSERV.UIC.EDU>

on behalf of

Berry, Vikas <vikasb@uic.edu>

Date Mon 9/11/2023 11:33 AM

To CHE-FACULTY@LISTSERV.UIC.EDU <CHE-FACULTY@LISTSERV.UIC.EDU>

Dear All,

Thanks to all for participating in the faculty meeting last week and for your service in the department committees. Below are the committee assignments:

Per the votes, here is the composition of the department advisory committee: Ying Liu, Lew Wedgewood, Brian Chaplin, Sangil Kim, Betul Bilgin, Alan Zdunek

DEPARTMENT COMMITTEES	COMMITTEE MEMBERS 2023-24
Graduate Committee:	Ying, Ezinne, Anh, Brian, Shafigh
Undergraduate Committee:	Alan, Korosh, Lew, Vivek
Lab and Building Safety	Brian, Michael and Jan
Award Committee	Betul and Michael
Website Committee:	Jan and Meghan
PR Committee	Meghan, Alan, Betul, Meenesh (AIChE)
Seminar Committee:	Shafigh, Rodrigo, and Sangil
Diversity, Equity and Inclusion Committee:	Betul, Meenesh, Meghan, Eddie, Ying, Ezinne, Rodrigo, Korosh
CHE 101	Betul, Alan, Meenesh, Lew and Michael

Thanks!

Best,
Vikas

Vikas Berry (he/him/his)
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Recent Publications: [Nature Photonics](#), [Nano Letters](#), [ACS-AMI](#)

Recent News: [The Hill](#), [The Economist](#), [Washington Post](#), [Wall Street Journal](#); and [Zee-News](#).

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For Scheduling Zoom Meeting contact Ms. Sarai Chavez (schave22@uic.edu)

Zoom Meeting Link (by Appointment Only): <https://uic.zoom.us/my/vikasberry>.

"What is Chemical Engineering?"

UIC-Chemical Engineering Ranked #24 (QS Ranking) amongst US public universities

Faculty Meeting Minutes (Oct 13, 2023)

1. Hiring Update

Discussion regarding the draft letter for Argonne National Lab.

- Sangil and Ying put their thoughts about Tao's case.
- Vikas: we need to be clear with the new hires regarding lab space.
- Vikas: we may get one lab space from mechanical department.
- Ying thoughts are not to drop Tao's application.
- Vikas: despite of very positive points about Tao, we are constrained about space in hiring new candidates.
- Vikas: Let us pause Tao's application, but in the meantime lets plan on hiring a candidate from Argonne.

2. Advisory Committee

Members of the advisory committee: BB, AZ, LW, BC, SK, and YL.

- This is new advisory committee for this academic year.
- Defining roles of advisory committee in hiring:
 - No comments from others, so we are moving to next point.

3. Academic Program Review

Proposed reviewers for the IBHE academic program review.

- Ying: preparing documents, seeks help from Alan with sharing his documents.
- Ying: self-assessment report before end of semester approval from → dean → provost
 - After PhD defense, we decide that chair of committee to fill the assessment form. Otherwise, Ying cannot sign/approve.
 - In future, we may have one after prelims as well, where an assessment form must be submitted.

Dates for the review: March 28-29, April 18-19, April 25-26.

- Two reviewers: Ron Larson from U. Michigan and Wesley Burghardt from Northwestern

4. FELP (Faculty Entrepreneurship Leadership Program)

- Vikas: large group of people are interested in this program
- FELP will help with hosting 4 workshops
- Ying Liu's expressed interest in joining FELP.

5. Abbvie

- Abbvie's interest in hiring and participation in graduate programs and other events.
- Vikas asked us to let him know if they have any existing collaboration with Abbvie.
 - Ying has connection with formulations department of Abbvie
 - Ying will provide more details to Vikas on this.
- Mutual support

6. Joshua Olusaji won Entgris scholarship (25K\$ per year for 3 years).

7. Vamsi Gande and Rohit Chauhan to be interviewed by the advisory committee.

8. Seminar Management Committee:

- Shafigh is already involved.

Faculty Meeting Minutes (Oct 13, 2023)

- Shafigh: happy to help with inviting guests.
 - Vikas/Meenesh suggestions: provide T-cards to avoid refund issues.
 - Meenesh suggestion with implementing Seminar timing at 4 pm and refreshments/reception after 5 pm.
 - Shafigh: Friday afternoons at 3 or 4 pm are better for students/faculty attendance.
 - Vikas: difficult to change timeslots for this academic year.
 - Shafigh: will ask other faculties if they can move their classes for next semester.
 - Vikas: cookies/food after seminar.
 - Alan: Friday afternoons are better.
 - Shafigh: Fall 2024, takes vote from faculty and move seminars to Friday afternoon.
9. AIChE meeting:
- Betul, Meenesh, Vikas are going.
 - Two events: Sunday (recruitment) and Tuesday (reception).
 - Working on card to send out soon.
10. National Council of Competitiveness:
- Half of the department names are sent for “the future of sustainability”
 - Few names were sent for “Future of Technology”
 - “Future of work and work force” (Betul name was sent) and
 - “Future of place-based innovations” names are yet to be decided.
 - Vikas asking us to send him names for the last two counsels.
11. Changing name of the department
- Vikas will share the curriculum plans with Alan and Ying.
12. Interaction with freshman class:
- Vikas asking Alan’s help.
13. Staff hiring updates: no applicants yet.
14. Incoming students declining for undergrad and master students.
- PhD students’ number increased.
 - Applications are now open for Spring 2023.
 - Zac Adesanya and Yuli Zhu helping with student recruitments (collecting nominations from current students).

Alans Meeting minutes:

1. Undergraduate Recruitment-
- a. UIC Major/Minor Fair October 3rd
- i. Chemical Engineering table (next to COE and Breakthrough Tech).
 - ii. Undeclared engineering students - ChE minor interest by CS students.
 - iii. LAS students- Math, Chemistry majors.
- b. Help with undergraduate and graduate recruitment activities- Zac Adesanya, Yuli Zhu
- i. Updating flyers/brochures.
 - ii. Updating HS contact list (counselors, science teachers, etc.)
 - iii. Advertising.

Faculty Meeting Minutes (Oct 13, 2023)

2. Advising Week October 23-27

- a. Advising timeslots spreadsheet sent out by Eddie Martinez this week.
- b. Students sign up next week- follow up.
- c. Advising FAQ'S, Updated Semester Course Schedule and Flowchart (Core BS and Concentrations)
 - i. Revise and send out next week.
- d. Advising sessions- Use iAdvise.

Ying minutes:

1. Graduate student's admissions.

- Spring 2024
 - We have 5 PhD and 1 master student applications so far.
 - Accepted 1 master and 3 PhD (by Vikas and Meenesh)
 - If no one is interested, Ying is going to deny those remaining 2 candidates.
- For Fall 2024:
 - A lot of applications came in.
 - Application fee waivers: If applied before Dec 15th
 - 25 waivers for international fee
 - Is it first-come-first serve? (or)
 - Faculty endorsement?
 - Vikas suggestion:
 - Ying will decide/prioritize first based on the favoring based on endorsement and then it will be first-come-first?
 - Bio Eng. Faculty is doing information sessions (Nov 15) – overview of their research.
 - Ying is busy this year, also she seeks Eddies help to inform all applicants.

2. Survey of the seniors (interested in UIC graduate studies):

- Betul agreed to help with this survey.
- Vikas emailed list of all domestic students.

3. Executive committee (Ying: Not much)

4. Diversity committee (Betul: nothing)

5. CHE 101 course (Betul meeting with committee)

6. Updates on Department Action Teams (DAT)

- Betul and Korosh: set of actionable goals.
- Korosh: Like to have Alan in DAT meeting.

7. Shafigh: can we facilitate MS in data science for CHE bachelor?

- Vikas: if it is 1 year course, then yes, we can advertise our own bachelors, providing good skill sets.
- Betul: 4+1 program can be a potential?
- Vikas: we can discuss more with their department on this.

MINUTES FOR CHE FACULTY MEETING

FRIDAY, Jan 19, 2024 (1:00 PM – 2:30 PM)

Vikas minutes:

1. **Union Representative**

Priya presented at the faculty meeting about importance of joining the Union.

2. **Hiring Update**

- Lunch welcome (Cassandra A. Wilson, department of surgery)

3. ChemEConnect is on Jan 23rd at 12 noon and AICHE Midwest conference is Mar 5th and 6th.

4. Space proposal was submitted: requested for EIB 173 and 273, an office space and student space. More details will be updated later.

5. COE leadership job (as associate dean of research): if anyone is interested, reach out to Vikas. Requirement is “full professor.”

6. UIC-ICORP starts on Mar 26th, and info session on Jan 30th, if interested please reach out to Vikas.

7. New forms (watch for an email from Vikas)

- an electronic form available for traveling.
- for ordering chemicals, students send the filled new forms to their PI for approval and the PI sends to Sarai for ordering.

8. Mentor health issues: if students are absent for long time, please contact/report to “behavioral response intervention team at UIC.”

9. If there are any compelling issues or HR processing issues, please let Vikas know, he will discuss with provost.

10. AY25 courses for next year: send Vikas about your preferences.

11. Legacy wall is open, in our website: complete faculty list is available. If you find any errors, please let Megan know about them.

12. Enrollment:

- 5-Day came down to 167 from 180 (compared to last year)
- 10-day will be updated soon.

13. Application summary: good news is that applications are up by 36% in CHE undergrad and admits are up by 28%.

- Although overall enrollments are up by 36%, women applications went up only 2%.
- More of the women applications are going to BME and ENV.
- COE increased by 2.77% and CS went down by 10%.

14. Research Expenditure:

- CHE = \$2,977,374 (close to CME)
- The change is +21%

MINUTES FOR CHE FACULTY MEETING

FRIDAY, Jan 19, 2024 (1:00 PM – 2:30 PM)

Alans Meeting minutes:

Undergraduate Report: Faculty Meeting, January 19, 2024

1. Undergraduate Recruitment/Application Reports

- a. As of January 9th report:
 - i. ChE Admits-84 (67 last year)
 - ii. ChE Accepted Offer- 2 (0 last year)
 - iii. ChE Incomplete applications- 32 (25 last year)
 - iv. Engineering Undeclared Admits- 207, 3 Accepted offer
- b. Application numbers up from last year
- c. Emails were sent to all cohorts above
- d. Women in Engineering Scholarship Brunch- February 17th
- e. IGNITE recruitment event- April 20th
- f. ChE Lab Coat Ceremony- Date TBD

2. CHE 300-level course Pre-requisite registration check

- a. Currently our 200-level courses are flagged when students try to register and do not have the required pre-requisites.
- b. UG committee will review 300-level course pre-requisites for accuracy/revision and then submit to college to include in registration check.

3. Online Catalog Review and Update

4. External Advisor Board meeting this semester- Date to be determined.

- a. *Vikas comment: Betul does the design showcase, a mini expo.*
 - i. *Held on last week of classes.*
- b. *We can combine these two, the external advisory board can visit both.*

5. Spring Semester Alumni Mixer- Date to be determined.

MINUTES FOR CHE FACULTY MEETING

FRIDAY, Jan 19, 2024 (1:00 PM – 2:30 PM)

Ying minutes:

1. Graduate student's admissions

- We have 17 for master's and
- 51 Completed applications for PhD
 - Committee is reviewing the applications right now.
 - Change in reviewers committee- Anh, Shafigh, Brian and Ezinne
 - Planning to meet on Jan 26th
 - Master's admission will be decided by Ying.
 - Faculty members can contact Eddie for reviewing applications.
 - Applications will be emailed to faculty as PDF. (further discussion is needed on placing them on Box)
- Less diversity in applications
 - Large number of applications are from Iran, second biggest are from India.
 - Less number of domestic applications

2. IBHE report

- Submits them by end of January'24.

3. Reviewers site visit:

- We have reviewers site visit on April 25-26

Betul's comment:

- For the society of women engineers' conference is in Chicago (Oct 24-26)
- We can involve women graduate students and can have a table at the conference.

Ezinne's comment:

- Application for GEM consortium
- Program focusses on masters' and PhD students

Vikas comment: Let us connect with the students on graduate symposium for this year

4. Diversity committee (Betul: nothing)

5. Updates on Department Action Teams (DAT)

- Welcome back event is postponed to Jan 23rd, open to students and faculty.

Respectfully submitted,

Naveen K. Dandu

MINUTES FOR CHE FACULTY MEETING

FRIDAY, Feb 16, 2024 (1:00 PM – 2:00 PM)

Vikas minutes:

1. Course schedule for Fall semester:
 - 9 and 7 electives for undergraduate and graduate level courses are listed, yet to be finalized.
 - The course schedules shown today are not final yet. Vikas will discuss with Eddie in finalizing the course schedule.
 - Brian requested a change in time for his course. Shafigh is ready to swap with his course schedule.
 - Participating in advising is mandatory for every faculty. If you are not ready for advising, you must teach one extra course.
2. Alan, Ezinne, Eddie and Betul are attending “women in engineering scholarship brunch.”
 - 5 CHE applicants.
 - Thanks to Betul and Ezinne.
3. IBHE review is coming up,
 - Ying has worked on it.
4. UIC-ICORP starts on Mar 26th,
 - If you are interested in attending, please reach out to Vikas.
5. For the whiteboard ceremony
 - Videos will be sent out to the admitted students.
 - The ceremony is going to be in Summer.
6. Commencement is going to be on May 4th, 2024.
 - If your students are graduating this semester, please either you or have your representative faculty member be available at the ceremony.
7. Emergency funds are available.
 - If any of your students need emergency funding, please contact Vikas.
8. Enrollment:
 - 10-day enrollment went down to 171 from 180 (compared to last year).
 - PhD enrollment is 46, and MS enrollment is only 9 right now (it has been around 20 in the previous years).
 - Ying commented that a lot of the MS students are converting to PhD (a reason why MS applications are dropping). Ying will update more on this.
9. Application summary: The good news is that applications are up by 29.03%.
 - Overall enrollments are up by 43.75%, women applications went up 11%.
 - More of the women applications are going to BME (56%) and ENV (60%).
 - COE increased by 1.64% and CS went down by 11.63%.
 - Meenesh had a question on this analysis. Vikas will discuss it in detail in the next faculty meeting.
10. Graduate applications:
 - PhD applications are 57 (down by 6.56%) and MS applications went up by 33.33%.
 - Admits (Ying is working on the numbers).

MINUTES FOR CHE FACULTY MEETING

FRIDAY, Feb 16, 2024 (1:00 PM – 2:00 PM)

- Sangil requested Ying to provide demographic information of the applicants.
 - Brian put forth a concern about admitting a lot of students from one country, but faculty are not taking them.
 - Meenesh suggested a pre-screen processing before admitting, involving PIs to review.
 - Ying requested faculty members to review the applications, as they have access to the files. Moreover, she is requesting faculty members to forward emails they receive from applicants.
11. Training students for their betterment (improve PhD program):
- Ezinne suggested a preliminary examination (3 credit course), defending a proposal, before defending their PhD thesis.
 - Defending a research proposal in front of a committee that involves three faculty members.

Alans Meeting minutes:

Undergraduate Report: Faculty Meeting, Feb 16, 2024

- 1. Undergraduate Recruitment/Application Reports**
 - a. As of February 13th report:
 - i. ChE Admits-110
 - ii. ChE Accepted Offer- 5 (2 rejected offer)
 - iii. ChE Incomplete applications- 41
 - iv. Engineering Undeclared Admits- 335, 5 Accepted offer
 - b. Application numbers up from last year
 - c. Emails continually sent to all cohorts above
 - d. Women in Engineering Scholarship Brunch- February 17th
 - i. Vikas, Betul, Ezinne, Eddie
 - ii. 5 ChE applicants
- 2. CHE 300-level course Pre-requisite check**
 - a. Under review by UG committee for accuracy/revision
- 3. Online Catalog Review and Update- Due March**
- 4. External Advisor Board meeting this semester- Coordinate with ChE Senior Design EXPO 4/22**
- 5. Spring Semester Alumni Mixer- TBD: April?**

MINUTES FOR CHE FACULTY MEETING

FRIDAY, Feb 16, 2024 (1:00 PM – 2:00 PM)

Ying minutes:

1. College executive committee meeting

- Joint appointment (Recruiting people from Argonne).
- Interviewing more people?
- **Vikas comment:** Tao Li is more promising; he got another new grant. Interested in taking him.
- Anh commented that he has good funding, a lot from NSF and 1 or 2 from DOE.
- Meenesh suggested advertising the job as an open position. According to Vikas, we cannot advertise a job post without Argonne's approval.

Entrepreneurship:

- **Said minutes.**
 - Hardtech innovation summit: building wet labs, recruiting battery companies.
 - They are focusing more on batteries now. Looking to showcase some technologies.
 - Anybody who wants to nominate themselves, are encouraged to do so.

Respectfully submitted,

Naveen K. Dandu